Hamza-tul Qata' (ء)
& Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

There are two types of Hamzah in the Quran. They have different forms and rules.

A) Hamza-tul Qata' (ء)

Definition:

The letter Hamzah appears in many different forms in the Arabic language, but it is pronounced according to the Harakah above or below the Hamza.

Examples:

ء - ؤ - ئ - أ - إ

Hamza-tul Qata' can either be at the beginning, or in the middle, or at the end of a word.

Examples:

سَمَاءٌ - بِئْسَ - بَرِيۤءٌ - مُؤْمِنَة - سَأَلَ - أَحْمَد - ءَأَنْتُم

Note:

The Alif and Hamzah are 2 different letters. For Uthmani script, the letter Alif will never have Harakah whilst for Indo Pak script, the letter Alif may have Harakahs. In the latter case, the Alif is pronounced as Hamzah.

Hamza-tul Qata' (ء) & Hamza-tul Wasl (أ)

A) Hamza-tul Qata' (ء)

Common Mistakes:

1- Not pronouncing the همزة clearly when it is repeated.

Examples: ءَأَنتَ – ءَإِنَّكَ

2- Not pronouncing the عين from the right point of articulation when preceded by همزة.

Examples: أَعُوذُ – أَعْلَمُ

3- همزة should be pronounced clearly when it is Saakin otherwise it will be pronounced as the letters of Madd.

Examples: مُؤْصَدَةٌ - شِئْتُمْ - فَأْتُوا

B) Hamza-tul Wasl (أ)

Definition: Hamzah-tul Wasl is pronounced when starting the words, and dropped when continuing.

Hamzah-tul Wasl appears only at the beginning of a word. It has a little saad written on top of Alif (صـ). If the reciter starts reciting from a word that begins with Hamza-tul Wasl, then it should be pronounced with Harakah. However, it is not pronounced when joining the word that starts with Hamzah-tul Wasl with the previous word.

Hamzah-tul Wasl can be pronounced with i) Fathah, ii) Kasrah or iii) Dhammah according to the following letter.

Hamza-tul Qata' (ء) & Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

B) Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

i) It is pronounced with a Fathah when it is at the beginning of a noun and is followed by Laam Shamseeyah or Laam Qamareeyah.

Examples:

ٱلْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ ٱلْعَالَمِينَ ۝٢ سُورَةُ الْفَاتِحَة الآية

ii) It is pronounced with a Kasrah when it is at the beginning of a verb and the third letter of the verb has a Fathah or a Kasrah.

Examples:

إِلا إِبْلِيسَ ٱسْتَكْبَرَ وَكَانَ مِنْ ٱلْكَافِرِينَ ۝٧٤ سُورَةُ ص الآية

ٱسْتَغْفِرْ لَهُمْ أَوْ لا تَسْتَغْفِرْ لَهُمْ ۝٨٠ سُورَةُ التَّوْبَة الآية

It is also pronounced with a Kasrah in seven nouns in the Quran. For example:

1- وَنَادَى نُوحٌ رَبَّهُ فَقَالَ رَبِّ إِنَّ ٱبْنِي مِنْ أَهْلِي وَإِنَّ وَعْدَكَ الْحَقُّ وَأَنْتَ أَحْكَمُ الْحَاكِمِينَ ۝٤٥ سُورَةُ هُود الآية

2- وَمَرْيَمَ ٱبْنَتَ عِمْرَانَ ٱلَّتِي أَحْصَنَتْ فَرْجَهَا ۝١٢ سُورَةُ التَّحْرِيم الآية

Hamza-tul Qata' (ء) & Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

B) Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

3- إِنِ ٱمْرُؤٌ هَلَكَ سُورَةُ النِّسَاء الآية ١٧٦

4- وَإِنْ ٱمْرَأَةٌ خَافَتْ مِنْ بَعْلِهَا نُشُوزًا أَوْ إِعْرَاضًا فَلا جُنَاحَ عَلَيْهِمَا أَنْ يُصْلِحَا بَيْنَهُمَا صُلْحًا وَالصُّلْحُ خَيْرٌ سُورَةُ النِّسَاء الآية ١٢٨

5- وَقَالَ اللَّهُ لَا تَتَّخِذُوا إِلَهَيْنِ ٱثْنَيْنِ إِنَّمَا هُوَ إِلَهٌ وَاحِدٌ فَإِيَّايَ فَارْهَبُونِ سُورَةُ النَّحْل الآية ٥١

6- نِسَاءً فَوْقَ ٱثْنَتَيْنِ سُورَةُ النِّسَاء الآية ١١

7- سَبِّحِ ٱسْمَ رَبِّكَ الأَعْلَى سُورَةُ الْأَعْلَى الآية ١

iii) It is pronounced with a Dhammah when it is at the beginning of a verb and the third letter of the verb has a Dhammah.

Examples:

فَمَنِ ٱضْطُرَّ غَيْرَ بَاغٍ وَلا عَادٍ فَلا إِثْمَ عَلَيْهِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ سُورَةُ البَقَرَة الآية ١٧٣

ٱدْعُ إِلَى سَبِيلِ رَبِّكَ بِالْحِكْمَةِ وَالْمَوْعِظَةِ الْحَسَنَةِ سُورَةُ النَّحْل الآية ١٢٥

Hamza-tul Qata' (ء) & Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

B) Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

Exception:

The following 5 verbs in the Quran are pronounced with Kasrah. Although the third letter has a Dhammah but the reciter starts with a Kasrah as the Dhammah is not part of the original verb due to grammatical rules:

1- ثُمَّ ٱقْضُوا إِلَيَّ وَلَا تُنظِرُونِ

سُورَةُ يُونُس الآية ٧١

2- فَقَالُواْ ٱبْنُواْ عَلَيْهِم بُنْيَـٰنًا رَّبُّهُم أَعْلَمُ بِهِم

سُورَةُ الكَهْف الآية ٢١

3- وَٱمْضُواْ حَيْثُ تُؤْمَرُونَ

سُورَةُ الْحِجْر الآية ٦٥

4- وَٱنطَلَقَ ٱلْمَلَأُ مِنْهُم أَنِ ٱمْشُواْ وَٱصْبِرُواْ عَلَىٰٓ ءَالِهَتِكُم

سُورَةُ ص الآية ٦

5- فَأَجْمِعُواْ كَيْدَكُم ثُمَّ ٱئْتُواْ صَفًّا

سُورَةُ طه الآية ٦٤

Hamza-tul Qata' (ء) & Hamza-tul Wasl (ٱ)

The differences between Hamza-tul Wasl and Hamza-tul Qata' are noted in the following table :

Hamza-tul Qata'	Hamza-tul Wasl
It can either be at the beginning, or in the middle, or at the end of a word.	It appears only at the beginning of a word.
It is always pronounced, whether the reciter starts by reciting from a word that begins with Hamza-tul Qata' or joins it to the previous word.	It is pronounced if the reciter starts reciting from a word that begins with Hamza-tul Wasl. It is, however, not pronounced when joining the word that starts with Hamzah-tul Wasl with the previous word.
It can have a Harakah or a Sukoon. Its pronunciation doesn't depend on the following letter.	It has no Harakah on top of it and is pronounced with a Fathah or a Kasrah or a Dhammah, according to the following letter.
It appears in different forms.	It has only one form.

The Meeting of Hamza-tul Wasl and Hamza-tul Qata' in One Word

There are two ways that this occurs:
a) Hamza-tul Wasl precedes the Hamza-tul Qata'
b) Hamza Qata' precedes the Hamza-tul Wasl (questioning Hamza)(1)

A) Hamza-tul Wasl Precedes a Hamza-tul Qata' which is Saakinah

Examples:

1- فَإِنْ أَمِنَ بَعْضُكُم بَعْضًا فَلْيُؤَدِّ ٱلَّذِى ٱؤْتُمِنَ أَمَـٰنَتَهُۥ ۗ وَلْيَتَّقِ ٱللَّهَ رَبَّهُۥ سورة البَقَرَة الآية ٢٨٣

2- وَقَالُوا۟ يَـٰصَـٰلِحُ ٱئْتِنَا بِمَا تَعِدُنَآ إِن كُنتَ مِنَ ٱلْمُرْسَلِينَ سورة الْأَعْرَاف الآية ٧٧

3- وَمِنْهُم مَّن يَقُولُ ٱئْذَن لِّى وَلَا تَفْتِنِّىٓ ۚ سورة التَّوْبَة الآية ٤٩

4- فَأَجْمِعُوا۟ كَيْدَكُمْ ثُمَّ ٱئْتُوا۟ صَفًّا ۚ سورة طه الآية ٦٤

5- ٱئْتُونِى بِكِتَـٰبٍ مِّن قَبْلِ هَـٰذَآ سورة الْأَحْقَاف الآية ٤

There are two rulings:

1- Hamza-tul wasl is not pronounced when the word starting with it is joined to the preceding word.

Note (1): A Questioning Hamzah is a Hamzah which turns a statement to a question.

The Meeting of Hamza-tul Wasl and Hamza-tul Qata' in One Word

2- If the reciter starts reciting the word that has Hamza-tul wasl, it is pronounced with Harakah according to the following letter, Hamza-tul Qata' is changed to a letter of Madd according to the Harakah of Hamza-tul wasl. The following words will show how the previous examples are pronounced when the reciter starts reading these words:

1- أُوتُمِنَ

2- إِيتِنَا

3- إِيذَن

4- إِيتُواْ

5- إِيتُونِى

B) Hamza-tul Qata' Precedes Hamza-tul Wasl (Questioning Hamzah).

Hamza-tul Wasl will have two rulings in three nouns that occur in the Quran:

1- Hamza-tul Wasl will change to an Alif Madd and will be prolonged 6 Harakas as it is followed by a Saakin letter.

2- Tasheel will be done on Hamza-tul Wasl. Tasheel means pronouncing Hamza-tul Wasl as a sound which is neither Hamza nor Alif Madd, but a sound in between. No elongation will be done.

The Meeting of Hamza-tul Wasl and Hamza-tul Qata' in One Word

All the words are mentioned in the Quran:

قُلْ ءَآللَّهُ أَذِنَ لَكُمْ ۖ سُوْرَةُ يُونُس الآية ٥٩

ءَآللَّهُ خَيْرٌ أَمَّا يُشْرِكُونَ سُوْرَةُ النَّمْل الآية ٥٩

ءَآلْـٰٔنَ وَقَدْ كُنتُم بِهِۦ تَسْتَعْجِلُونَ سُوْرَةُ يُونُس الآية ٥١

ءَآلْـٰٔنَ وَقَدْ عَصَيْتَ قَبْلُ وَكُنتَ مِنَ ٱلْمُفْسِدِينَ سُوْرَةُ يُونُس الآية ٩١

قُلْ ءَآلذَّكَرَيْنِ حَرَّمَ أَمِ ٱلْأُنثَيَيْنِ سُوْرَةُ الأَنْعَام الآية ١٤٤ ١٣٤

Notes:

The word ٱلْأَيْكَةِ occurs four times in the Quran.

i) It occurs twice with Hamza-tul Wasl in the following Ayahs:

1- وَإِن كَانَ أَصْحَـٰبُ ٱلْأَيْكَةِ لَظَـٰلِمِينَ سُوْرَةُ الْحِجْر الآية ٧٨

2- وَأَصْحَـٰبُ ٱلْأَيْكَةِ وَقَوْمُ تُبَّعٍ سُوْرَة ق الآية ١٤

The Meeting of Hamza-tul Wasl and Hamza-tul Qata' in One Word

Hamza-tul Wasl will be pronounced with Fathah when the reciter begins reading these words without joining with the previous words.

ii) It occurs twice without Hamza-tul Wasl in the following Ayahs:

1- كَذَّبَ أَصۡحَٰبُ لۡـَٔيۡكَةِ ٱلۡمُرۡسَلِينَ سُورَةُ الشُّعَرَاء الآية ١٧٦

2- وَثَمُودُ وَقَوۡمُ لُوطٖ وَأَصۡحَٰبُ لۡـَٔيۡكَةِۖ سُورَةُ ص الآية ١٣

Hamza-tul Wasl will be added to the above examples and pronounced with a Fathah when the reciter begins reading these words without joining with the previous words.

The word ٱلِاسۡم that occurs in Surah Al-Hujurat has two pronunciations when the reciter starts by this word.

بِئۡسَ ٱلِٱسۡمُ ٱلۡفُسُوقُ بَعۡدَ ٱلۡإِيمَٰنِۚ سُورَةُ الحُجُرَات الآية ١١

1- Hamza-tul Wasl is pronounced with a Fathah and that is the preference.

It will be pronounced as follows: أَلِاسۡم

2- Hamza-tul Wasl is dropped and the Laam is pronounced with a Kasrah. It will be pronounced as follows: لِاسۡم

Exercises

1- What are the differences between Hamza-tul Wasl and Hamza-tul Qata'?

2- Complete the following:
a) Hamza-tul Wasl is pronounced with ..... when it is at the beginning of a noun and is followed by Laam Shamseeyah and Laam Qamareeyah.
b) Hamza-tul Wasl is pronounced with ..... when it is at the beginning of a verb and the third letter of the verb has a Fathah or a Kasrah.
c) Hamza-tul Wasl is pronounced with ..... when it is at the beginning of a verb and the third letter of the verb has a Dhammah.

3- How should the reciter begin his recitation from the words written in red below:

a) وَمَرْيَمَ ٱبْنَتَ عِمْرَانَ ٱلَّتِي أَحْصَنَتْ فَرْجَهَا
b) ٱدْعُ إِلَى سَبِيلِ رَبِّكَ بِالْحِكْمَةِ وَالْمَوْعِظَةِ الْحَسَنَةِ
c) فَأَجْمِعُوا۟ كَيْدَكُمْ ثُمَّ ٱئْتُوا۟ صَفًّا
d) ٱئْتُونِي بِكِتَـٰبٍ مِّن قَبْلِ هَـٰذَا
e) قُلْ ءَآللَّهُ أَذِنَ لَكُمْ
f) كَذَّبَ أَصْحَـٰبُ لْـَٔيْكَةِ ٱلْمُرْسَلِينَ
g) وَأَصْحَـٰبُ ٱلْأَيْكَةِ وَقَوْمُ تُبَّعٍ